

and made available in the market – this has shrunk in a big way. Hence, the developers are thinking along the lines of how they can get their app or piece of code in the store or onto any other platform they choose to deploy it, as fast as they can. Then, they look at all possible tools in the environment.

Getting involved with Intel's initiatives for developers

Q Does Intel have any programme that involves developers with its platforms?

Basically, all the way from Atom to Xeon, we use these processors to build a variety of platforms. There are Atom-based platforms going into a variety of clamshell form factors, into embedded systems, and into phones and tablets. Then, there are Core-based platforms, which are used in the ultrabook category, and then there are the server platforms. For each of these platform levels, we have SDKs, tools, communities, events, contests, hackathons, mentoring incentives for start-ups, etc—pretty much helping developers in the engineering space and as much as possible, in the business space too. There is a very strong level of participation from Intel Capital, where we invest in companies from India. So, we have a spectrum of offerings for developers from India, from trying to get them a basic compiler or the SDK, to getting them to our business channel and potentially getting them access to small capital to get them started, and eventually get equity investments. We have been doing this consistently and we have grown in this domain over the last few years.

To answer your questions, depending upon what their target market is, developers get various benefits from Intel, right from the platform to the SDKs, tools, etc. How they choose to sell depends upon whom they are trying to sell to. If a company is building an Android application, its predominant choice would be Google Play when it comes to selling the app. But we give developers tools to make the applications a lot more productive on our architecture.

Q What are your initiatives for developers in India, particularly for open source developers?

As far as our developer programmes are concerned, we work with the top high performance computing (HPC) installations in the country, where most of them work with a variety of open source projects. This is beyond supporting the community initiatives, which include making sure that online communities are available. We also work with academic institutions to provide them the tools. SDKs are provided to academia in a very different model. If you move higher, you find all the HPC installations. You know HPC is typically customised

open source work load. We practically work with all the large HPC installations across the country to make sure that their open source work loads are adapted to our platforms. At a worldwide level, if you pick the top 5-7 most popular workloads, most of them are constantly getting optimised for our architecture. For instance, Hadoop is very well optimised for our architecture and the developers have access to it. Practically, anyone and everyone who takes Hadoop and works in it, deploys it or optimises and builds applications on top of it, gets the benefit of our open source investments.

If you notice, the level of abstraction in the open source world is moving higher and higher; at the same time, all our experts are constantly investing in making sure that the kernel is more robust, and that new features come in the mobile space. We have some of the best emulators in the Android space as well.

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Q If I plan on a start-up and want to reach out to Intel, how should I go about it?

You can call a bunch of people at Intel Capital and they can help you. There are some Intel Capital representatives based in India who are really active within the industry. They are Skyping, they are listening, they are connected to the industry in every way—they work with co-investors, constantly trying to provide good opportunities. There is a constant flow of ideas and, depending upon the state of the company, the appropriate resources are provided.

If yours is a three-person start-up, which is coming up with an application for ultrabooks around education, you may not be ready for Intel Capital, but you are definitely in for my developers' programme where you will be helped to turn your idea into a concept and data. Start-ups have access to hardware from me, they have access to tools from me, they can attend my developers' forums and join the community to reach a stage where they can design a prototype, work with some potential customers and get the product to the revenue-earning stage. When they reach the stage at which they need capital to grow further, that is the appropriate time for them to talk to Intel Capital. This does not mean Intel Capital doesn't talk to small start-ups. They help a lot of people and guide them. Their value to the community is not just the investments but also the guidance or strategic value that they provide.